

GAMAL TAWAF

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Professional Summary

Senior Software Engineer and Google Cloud Certified Professional Cloud Architect with 12+ years building mission-critical, high-reliability systems across fintech and large-scale platforms — global payment-card issuance at Binance, financial-services systems at Fiserv, and 10M+ user platforms at 99.9% uptime. Expert in real-time data, distributed systems, and cloud-native architecture; a proven leader who scaled teams and brought outsourced systems in-house for \$500K annual savings. Currently co-founding an early-stage technology venture and seeking senior software engineering and architecture roles where I can lead teams and own complex systems end-to-end.

Technical Skills

- **Cloud & Architecture:** Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Cloud Architecture, Distributed Systems, Microservices, High Availability, Scalable System Design, Cloud Run, Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker
- **Languages & Backend:** Python, Java, Spring Boot, Django, Flask, Node.js, Express.js, PHP, Laravel, Ruby on Rails
- **Data & Real-Time:** BigQuery, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Real-Time Data Pipelines, Vector Databases
- **CI/CD & Observability:** GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, CI/CD Automation, Monitoring & Observability
- **Testing:** pytest, JUnit, PHPUnit, Test Automation, Selenium
- **AI & Data:** Generative AI, LangChain, RAG Systems, Vertex AI, Gemini 2.5, GeoPandas
- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, Svelte, Vue.js, JavaScript, Tailwind CSS

Experience

Cofounder/CTO (Part-Time)

Confidential Technology Startup

April 2026 – Present
Riyadh, KSA (Remote)

- Founded and lead engineering for a Saudi-based technology venture, owning architecture, cloud strategy, and technical direction across distributed multi-timezone teams.
- Designed cloud architecture aligned to KSA data-residency, security, and governance requirements, selecting providers on a compliance-first basis.
- Built CI/CD and continuous-deployment pipelines from scratch, accelerating release cadence.
- Introduced AI-assisted development workflows (Claude Code and LLM coding agents) and a structured SDLC, accelerating delivery up to 10x.

Senior Software Engineer

Fiserv

Jan 2026 – Present
Toronto, ON

- Developed and maintained an internal financial services platform using Python, Flask, MySQL and Podman.
- Improved the onboarding process to ensure new hires can be set up in less than a day.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to implement rebranding of a client's front end.
- Introduced distributed tracing across the microservices architecture, improving observability and issue resolution.
- Led a new vendor integration initiative to deliver additional customer value and platform capabilities.
- Served as Feature Lead for multiple core platform features, driving enhancements and cross-team delivery.
- Managed and resolved on-call production issues to maintain system reliability and uptime.

Solution Architect/Engineering Team Lead

Inkeros

Jan 2025 – Jan 2026
Oakville, ON

- Recruited, managed, and mentored a diverse developer team from junior to senior levels, driving continuous skill development and high performance.

- Architected and led development of a mission-critical enterprise portal using Python and Django, automating workflows for 250+ staff and doubling operational efficiency with a scalable SaaS-ready design.
- Spearheaded creation of a fully automated CI/CD pipeline with comprehensive Docker containerization, GitHub Actions, Artifact Registry and Google Cloud Run achieving one-click deployment and a 99.8% success rate.
- Designed and implemented an AI automation system leveraging Google Cloud's Gemini 2.5 and Vertex AI to analyze audio call center recordings, orchestrated by GCP Workflows and stored in BigQuery, enhancing compliance and fraud prevention with actionable insights.
- Built AI-driven data pipelines (GeoPandas, Pandas, SERP & Google Maps APIs) using generative AI to increase lead-profiling efficiency by 400%, and prototyped a RAG system with LangChain and Vertex AI.
- Engineered a scalable backend architecture supporting 500+ concurrent users with GCP auto-scaling, reducing Mean Time to Resolution by 60%, and maintaining 99.9% uptime.

Senior Software Engineer

PERCS

Apr 2024 – Jan 2025

Remote

- Maintained and scaled full-stack platform features supporting rapid user-base growth, and integrated analytics to drive targeted product improvements.
- Built and launched Web3 gaming features on Warpcast Frames, including new v2 games during the protocol's development stage.

Senior Software Engineer (Contract)

UFT

Jan 2024 – Apr 2024

Toronto, ON

- Upgraded legacy Laravel system (v8 to v10), introduced unit testing (90% coverage), modernized local dev with Sail, and integrated Vue.js components to improve interactivity.

Senior Software Engineer

Binance – Card & Pay

Jul 2022 – Jul 2023

Remote

- Integrated global partner REST APIs enabling worldwide MasterCard issuance.
- Migrated card ordering from Laravel to Spring Boot, improving performance and scalability.
- Trained team members in Java and Spring Boot.
- Increased code coverage with unit testing, reducing defects.

Senior Web Engineer

VerticalScope Inc.

Jul 2021 – Jun 2022

Remote

- Designed and built features for forums serving 10M+ users, and launched a marketplace platform generating a new revenue stream.

Team Lead / Senior Software Developer

Afilias Canada

Feb 2016 – Jul 2021

Toronto, ON

- Recruited, managed, and mentored a developer team from junior to senior levels, driving continuous skill growth and high performance.
- Spearheaded in-house migration of a Ruby on Rails application from third-party dependency, upgrading Rails v3 to v5 and migrating MySQL to PostgreSQL in 6 months, yielding \$500K annual cost savings and full operational control.
- Assumed full ownership of 3 previously outsourced systems, transforming team capabilities and earning complete business confidence in in-house development from zero to full trust.

Earlier Roles: Application Developer, Carlton Group (2014–2016) | Web Developer, Golf Canada (2014) | Web Developer, PAVR Labs (2013–2014)

Certifications

Hugging Face AI Agents Course — Certificate of Excellence
Google Cloud Solution Architect Professional

2026
 2025 - 2027

Education

Bachelor of Computer Science – York University, Toronto, ON
Computer Programming Diploma – Seneca College, Toronto, ON

2014
 2011